

Country Boy

2026

Dimensions: 24 x 8 x 12 inches

Description: Bleeding green, like jade green, the emperor's lair and the army under his command; each becoming less and less prominent than the last. Encased, the boy finds himself lost in the endless columns of the catacomb, seeing the faded mirage of warriors just like himself. He remembers his old house, his grandparents' grave, and the place where he would have called home. Now it's no more, nothing more than communal history, unresolved.

Cubic Liminal

2026

Dimensions: 14 x 14 x 14 inches

Description: This project began as a collaboration with Pittsburgh photographer George Lange, exploring the liminal "boxes" that surround us in our everyday lives. I created an initial prototype in which the boxes were made of cardboard, with the interiors painted to represent shifting inner realities. We launched this on MLK Day at Club Café, inviting guests to wear the boxes and be photographed in support of UPMC Children's Hospital. The event produced a range of compelling images and helped us evaluate both the conceptual and material limits of the work, especially our desire to have better control over structure, surface, and the role of light.

Building on this, I collaborated with Allen Chen, a sophomore in architecture at Carnegie Mellon University, to develop a second prototype using digital fabrication to create a nicer finish on the outside. Inspired by the UPMC Children's Hospital initiative, we reflected on our childhood. By comparing and contrasting our cultural differences through memory, heritage, and nostalgia, we created two boxes that together form an amalgamation of our culture. The first reimaged portrait photographs from Lange's archive onto small painted wooden panels, where distortion and light emphasized fading memory and loss.

The second introduced fragmented, geometric openings inspired by childhood toy blocks, paired with an adjustable frosted acrylic panel to reflect the blur and instability of memory. Both boxes were painted red, referencing our shared East Asian heritage and evoking cultural nostalgia. We presented this prototype in a small studio event, where participants engaged directly with the work.

Our end goal for this project is currently in the planning stage. We aim to create a series where people can find their inner childhood, memories, and relationships through the experience of putting on a "liminal box". We hope to showcase the success through the combination of fine arts, architecture, and photography. Promoting interdisciplinary collaboration can shape shared experiences and build on each other's success.

Dancer's Hemorrhage

2026

Dimensions: 25 x 42 x 26 inches

Description: Beauty, pain, and the dwelling subconscious that goes without saying. In a world full of martyrs, the dancer sought not to be one. Beyond the physical, she dances without the gratification, just the sheer will and resilience to truly express herself. In contrast to the dancer, I often see myself as a victim of my environment, creating precarious excuses for circumstances I can fully overcome. Yet, when I fully realize just how lucky I am to be alive, to survive, even through unbearable pain and discomfort, a calmness overtakes me. Like David, who dances undignified in front of the lord with all his might, I must do the same. I must dance in the face of life and seek an overwhelming happiness that makes me forget the physical. The dancer carries her wounded body and a sign of resilience; she dances on, and so must I.

Dinner For One

2026

Dimensions: 48 x 56 x 50 inches

Description: We are always deciding whether to play the hand we are dealt or give in to pure absurdity. But that doesn't exist. The dinner that was served did not come from a place of brightness; instead, it came from a place of unreasonable silence. This place has no meaning, and things have no names. You can identify them as plates, cups, and photographs sitting on a tablecloth. For the victims who have fallen to the curse of *trying to find the meaning in this place of unreasonable silence*, this is their shrine. For those who took too long to gander but ultimately pulled away, this is their requiem. We keep trying to grasp the essence of the absurd. We pay much more attention to the sounds made by jagged rainfall than to stop and observe the eulogy left behind by those who gave in to chance. A chance of becoming a victim behind the silence, or the chance to forget this dinner and live inauthentically. I resorted to playing the hand that I was dealt.

Stay

2026

Dimensions: 62 x 38 x 36 inches

Description: To figure out the balance between living, dying, life, death, and everything in between. As people with a conscience, we tend to be hypercritical of how we tread the waves in the lives of everyone around us. Too much, and the scale tips, and too little, well, nothing moves. I wanted to explore the feeling of contentment, but also of stagnation, in our everyday lives. Sometimes, the wave of discernment hits me, and I simply do not want to pursue the things I once dreamed of. The chair's overall utility is also inspired by a hammock; the external springs at each end, along with the hinge in the middle, create the illusion of floating atop it. This emulates the feeling of suspension and losing control, something I think we should all experience a bit more to actually be in touch with reality. The inner lacings of the chair, such as the cushion and the casing, were heavily inspired by my grandma's medicine pill.

Being

2026

Dimensions: 1920 x 1080 px

Description: In this piece, *Being*, I explored the idea of both being myself and becoming myself through the burdens of my once-absent father. A direct memo to the years of contemplation and reflection about the man whom I only got to know recently. It is also about my overcomings, which drew heavily on my other piece "Therefore I Became" in both usage and meaning. These two pieces become intertwined in a way. Exploring deeper into the idea of Filial Piety, and how that does not apply in circumstances such as this one. As I have gotten older, I have felt more inclined to learn about and understand this strange man who claims to love me unconditionally, and not antagonize him. I am always in the process of becoming, and ultimately being. A boy who wanders, a son to a father.

The Way Forward

2026

Dimensions: 16 x 16 x 15 inches

Description: We focus a lot of our lives on pacing forward, yet we end up stagnant, bewildered by what is around us. I wanted to take a moment to rejoice and think about our own nature as well as the nature all around us. Mountains and the lake that surrounds our consciousness all lead to ultimate choices between our mind, soul, body, and vision (eye). What we see can be conceived as a primary understanding of the world, as we tend to believe. The arrows atop each mountain, controlled by yourself (who act as fate-controller), propel the gears that move the arrows that shape your own destiny. Each time you spin the lever, the arrows will line up at least three times in one direction out of ten rotations. Yet you seem to never decide which way they could land on, as life slowly moves away from you; what you decide on may not be the "correct way". In this instance, you become the tailwind that controls your destiny, the hand that is able to stir the wind into a direction you perceive. Through your eyes, you lead the right way (green arrows) into your soul. Through your soul, you then purge the mind and then your body. Through all the wind and senseless direction, I strive to find the way forward because we need to keep moving.